

Solid Ground

Soul-led business for women doing it solo

A free guide from Energy with Jess



SIX SECTIONS · PRACTICAL EXERCISES · WORKSHEETS INCLUDED

You found it.

Doing this alone is hard.

There is no one to ask at 10pm when you can't figure out how to word something. No one to split the bills while you work out whether this is actually going to work. No one to say "I think you should go for it" when you're three seconds away from talking yourself out of it again.

I built this guide specifically for that experience. Not starting a business in the abstract - starting one when it's all on you.

When the table is quiet and the decision is yours alone.

Each section has something you can actually do, not just read.

The worksheets at the back are yours to use however makes sense for your business and your life.

Start with one section. Start today.

You're already doing the hard part.

Jess x

What you actually need before you start

vs what everyone else tells you

01

The real reason solo women over-prepare isn't perfectionism.

It's that launching without a partner means launching without someone at home saying "this looks good, go for it." So the bar keeps moving. One more course. One more revision. One more "almost ready" - because the starting line also has to be the approval you're not getting from anywhere else.

Here's what you actually need:

Something to offer. A way to get paid.

One person who knows you exist.

The rest gets built in motion.

YOUR MINIMUM VIABLE START

- ☐ Something to offer (one service is enough to start)
- ☐ A way to take payment (Stripe, PayPal, bank transfer)
- ☐ One person who knows you exist

That's the whole business. Start there.

The "I'll start when..." trap

Spotting the stories that feel like responsibility

02

When you're the only income - or building alongside one - "start before you're ready" lands differently than it does in a business podcast.

It takes a different kind of nerve to begin when there's no one absorbing the financial risk with you. The stories feel less like fear and more like responsibility.

But those stories are not financial planning.

"I'll start when I have more money" is not a budget. It's protection. And it will move the goalposts forever.

Starting isn't irresponsible. It's the only way through.

NAME IT - THEN START ANYWAY

My current 'I'll start when...' story is:

What it's actually protecting me from:

One step I'll take this week regardless:

The free tools that do the job

No subscriptions before you've made a dollar

03

When you don't have a business partner to split costs with, you need to be deliberate about what you pay for and when.

The platforms that promise to streamline your business are designed for businesses already making money. You're not there yet - and that's not a problem. Start free.

Upgrade only when a tool is genuinely holding you back.

YOUR ZERO-COST TOOLKIT

Google Workspace Email, calendar, docs. Everything to run a business. Free.

Canva (free tier) Graphics, posts, documents, PDFs. No design skills needed.

Stripe or PayPal Take payment in 20 minutes. No setup costs.

Calendly (free) Booking link you can share anywhere. Clients sort themselves.

Instagram Your first shop window. Free. Start before it's perfect.

Where your first clients come from

Your network is smaller - and entirely yours

04

Your network is not a combined household network.

You don't have access to a partner's colleagues, their school friends, their LinkedIn connections. What you have is smaller. But it's 100% warm to you - not to a household, not to a couple. To you specifically.

That's not a disadvantage. The people who know you have seen you show up. When they refer you, they mean it.

Tell them what you do. Don't assume they know. Say it in a message, at pickup, in a post that feels a bit too honest. That vulnerability isn't oversharing. It's the beginning of trust.

A MESSAGE YOU CAN SEND TODAY

"Hey [name] - I just wanted to let you know I've started [what you do]. If you know anyone who might need [what you offer], I'd really appreciate the mention. No pressure."

Then post something too. Both. Today.

How to set up to get paid

When price carries more weight, get clear on it early

05

When you're the only one earning, your price carries more weight than it does for someone with a financial safety net.

That weight can push you to underprice. To add extras that weren't asked for. To discount before anyone asks.

To accept 'pay you later' and let it go.

Know your number before anyone asks for it.

Send a payment link, not 'let me know when you're ready.'

Invoice the day you deliver.

You're allowed to run your business like a real business, even in week one. Especially in week one.

One more thing: open a separate bank account just for business income. It doesn't need to be a business account - a separate personal account works. When your business money lives in its own place, you can actually see what's coming in. Your wins stay visible instead of disappearing into the household.

BEFORE YOUR FIRST CLIENT, CHECK OFF:

- ☐ My price is set and I can say it without hesitating
- ☐ Stripe or PayPal is set up and I've sent a test payment
- ☐ I have a payment link ready to send in under a minute
- ☐ I will invoice the same day I deliver - no exceptions
- ☐ A separate bank account for business income is open

Making decisions alone

When the table is quiet and it's all on you

06

There is no one at the kitchen table to ask.

Not just no business partner - no one. The decision sits with you at 11pm, and you're the only one it lands on.

Some things that actually help: trust your gut before the overthinking starts. Write it out - clarity comes in the writing, almost every time. Find your people, because there are communities of women doing exactly this who will get it without you having to explain.

And when you need a real thinking partner, book a session. That's not a weakness. That's knowing your resources.

You don't need all the answers. You just need to keep moving.

WHEN YOU'RE STUCK, WRITE IT OUT

The decision I keep circling:

What my gut said first, before the overthinking:

What I'll do by:

You don't need to have it all figured out.
You just need to begin.

WHAT'S NEXT?

Ready to go deeper?

The Solid Ground self-paced course takes every section further - exercises, prompts, and a clear path forward. Your pace, your time.

energywithjess.com.au — coming soon

Want to work through it with me?

Book an Align + Flow session or a Soul-Led Business Discovery Call.

We figure it out together.

energywithjess.com.au/booking

Come find me on Instagram

Real posts and honest talk about doing this solo.

[@energywithjess](https://www.instagram.com/energywithjess)

Weekly Money Check-in

One quick look at where you stand - no spreadsheet needed

Fill this in at the end of each week. You don't need to be exact.

The goal is awareness, not accounting.

Week of	Money in (\$)	Money out (\$)	Still to collect (\$)

One thing I noticed this week:

First Wins Log

No one else is tracking your progress - so you do it

Record your firsts here. Date them. These are the moments that prove it's working.

When it feels slow, come back to this page.

☐ First enquiry	DATE _____
☐ First booking	DATE _____
☐ First payment received	DATE _____
☐ First time I said my price without flinching	DATE _____
☐ First repeat client	DATE _____
☐ First referral from someone I know	DATE _____
☐ First stranger who found me online	DATE _____
☐ First moment I thought: this might actually work	DATE _____

My own milestone:

_____	DATE _____
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My Own Tracker

Label it yourself. Use it for whatever you need most right now.

This one's yours to make. Label the columns however works for you - clients, content, income, sessions, ideas, anything. No rules.

_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Use this for: clients / content / income / sessions / ideas / whatever you need